

3.4 Unit 3, Option B: Politics, Protest and Revolution

Focus

This option concentrates on how and why protest and agitation against established regimes developed in France and Britain in the late 18th and early 19th centuries. It focuses on what the impact of this protest and agitation was, regarding established revolutionary regimes and subsequent monarchical restoration in France and in terms of meeting the radical challenge within Britain. Students are required study a range of factors associated with the emergence and outcome of radical protest and the response it evoked. They also address, and are invited to pass reasoned judgement upon issues which have provoked disagreement and controversy among historians. A key element of study in this option relates to the evaluation of interpretations related to the failure of regimes in the late 18th and early 19th centuries in the case of France, and to the impact of radical political protest and rapid industrial change in the case of Britain.

Clarification of content for each topic can be found in *Appendix 1*.

Students entered for Option B are required to study ONE topic: B1 or B2.

**B1 France,
1786-1830:
Revolution,
Empire and
Restoration**

- The onset of revolution and the collapse of absolute monarchy, 1786-89.
- Terror and reaction, 1793-99: war and terror; the Thermidorean reaction and the Directory.
- France under Napoleon, 1799-1807: from Consulate to Empire; Napoleon's domestic reforms.
- The Bourbons restored: Louis XVIII and the Charter; Charles X and the Revolution of 1830.

Associated controversies

- a) Why did constitutional monarchy fail in the years 1789-92?
 - b) Why did the Napoleonic Empire collapse in 1814?
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**B2 Challenging
Authority:
Protest, Reform
and Response
in Britain,
c1760-1830**

- The revival of reform, c1760-85: reasons for, and significance of, movements associated with Wilkes and Wyvill; 'economical reform'; the County Association Movement.
- The impact of the French revolution, c1789-1815: the significance of Thomas Paine and the development of radicalism; extra-parliamentary protests, mass meetings and conspiracies.
- Responses to radicalism, c1780-1815: government policies designed to secure order; the Association Movement and popular loyalism; the impact of the evangelical revival and 'moral reform'; Sunday Schools.
- Conservatism and reform, c1812-30: changing attitudes towards reform; 'Liberal Toryism' and its impact — the roles of Huskisson and Robinson in commerce and Peel at the Home Office in the 1820s.

Associated controversies

- a) How much of a threat did extra-parliamentary reform protests and conspiracies pose to the authorities in the years 1815-30?
- b) Did the impact of the industrial revolution in the years c1780-1830 damage the lives and limit the opportunities of the labouring classes in Britain?